

0.0.1 Flowers

0. At Savatthi:

1. I, O bhikkhus, do not dispute with the world. It is indeed the world, O bhikkhus, that disputes with me. A speaker of the Dhamma, O bhikkhus, does not dispute with anyone in the world. That, O bhikkhus, which is regarded as non-existent in the world by the wise, I too say “it does not exist.” That, O bhikkhus, which is regarded as existent in the world by the wise, I too say “it does exist.”

2. And what, O bhikkhus, is regarded as non-existent in the world by the wise, of which I too say “it does not exist?”

3. Form, O bhikkhus, that is permanent, stable, eternal, not of a nature to degenerate, is regarded as non-existent in the world by the wise, of which I too say “it does not exist.” Feeling, O bhikkhus, that is permanent, stable, eternal, not of a nature to degenerate, is regarded as non-existent in the world by the wise, of which I too say “it does not exist.” Perception, O bhikkhus, that is permanent, stable, eternal, not of a nature to degenerate, is regarded as non-existent in the world by the wise, of which I too say “it does not exist.” Sankharas, O bhikkhus, that are permanent, stable, eternal, not of a nature to degenerate, are regarded as non-existent in the world

by the wise, of which I too say “they do not exist.” Consciousness, O bhikkhus, that is permanent, stable, eternal, not of a nature to degenerate, is regarded as non-existent in the world by the wise, of which I too say “it does not exist.” This, O bhikkhus, is that which is regarded as non-existent in the world by the wise, of which I too say “it does not exist.”

4. And what, O bhikkhus, is regarded as existent in the world by the wise, of which I too say “it does exist?”

5. Form, O bhikkhus, that is impermanent, painful, of a nature to degenerate, is regarded as existent in the world by the wise, of which I too say “it does exist.” Feeling, O bhikkhus, that is impermanent, painful, of a nature to degenerate, is regarded as existent in the world by the wise, of which I too say “it does exist.” Perception, O bhikkhus, that is impermanent, painful, of a nature to degenerate, is regarded as existent in the world by the wise, of which I too say “it does exist.” Sankharas, O bhikkhus, that are impermanent, painful, of a nature to degenerate, are regarded as existent in the world by the wise, of which I too say “they do exist.” Consciousness, O bhikkhus, that is impermanent, painful, of a nature to degenerate, is regarded as existent in the world by the wise, of which I too say “it does exist.” This, O bhikkhus, is that which is regarded as existent in the world by the wise, of which I too say “it does exist.”

6. There is, O bhikkhus, a worldly liability in the world which the Tathagata awakens and breaks through to. Having awoken to, having broken through to, he proclaims, explains, declares, establishes, reveals, analyzes, elucidates. And what, O bhikkhus, is the worldly liability in the world which the Tathagata awakens and breaks through to. Having awoken to, having broken through to, he proclaims, explains, declares, establishes, reveals, analyzes, elucidates?

7. Form, O bhikkhus, is a worldly liability in the world which the Tathagata awakens and breaks through to. Having awoken to, having broken through to, he proclaims, explains, declares, establishes, reveals, analyzes, elucidates. Whoever, O bhikkhus, does not know, does not see when the Tathagata is proclaiming, explaining, declaring, establishing, revealing, analyzing, elucidating thus, what, O bhikkhus, have I to do with that foolish puthujjana, blind and sightless, who [dwells] unknowing and unseeing.

8. Feeling, O bhikkhus, is a worldly liability in the world which the Tathagata awakens and breaks through to. Having awoken to, having broken through to, he proclaims, explains, declares, establishes, reveals, analyzes, elucidates. Whoever, O bhikkhus, does not know, does not see when the Tathagata is proclaiming, explaining, declaring, establishing, revealing, analyzing, elucidating thus, what, O bhikkhus, have I to do with that foolish

puthujjana, blind and sightless, who [dwells] unknowing and unseeing.

9. Perception, O bhikkhus, is a worldly liability in the world which the Tathagata awakens and breaks through to. Having awoken to, having broken through to, he proclaims, explains, declares, establishes, reveals, analyzes, elucidates. Whoever, O bhikkhus, does not know, does not see when the Tathagata is proclaiming, explaining, declaring, establishing, revealing, analyzing, elucidating thus, what, O bhikkhus, have I to do with that foolish puthujjana, blind and sightless, who [dwells] unknowing and unseeing.

10. Sankharas, O bhikkhus, are a worldly liability in the world which the Tathagata awakens and breaks through to. Having awoken to, having broken through to, he proclaims, explains, declares, establishes, reveals, analyzes, elucidates. Whoever, O bhikkhus, does not know, does not see when the Tathagata is proclaiming, explaining, declaring, establishing, revealing, analyzing, elucidating thus, what, O bhikkhus, have I to do with that foolish puthujjana, blind and sightless, who [dwells] unknowing and unseeing.

11. Consciousness, O bhikkhus, is a worldly liability in the world which the Tathagata awakens and breaks through to. Having awoken to, having broken through to, he proclaims, explains, declares, establishes, reveals,

analyzes, elucidates. Whoever, O bhikkhus, does not know, does not see when the Tathagata is proclaiming, explaining, declaring, establishing, revealing, analyzing, elucidating thus, what, O bhikkhus, have I to do with that foolish puthujjana, blind and sightless, who [dwells] unknowing and unseeing.

12. “Just as, O bhikkhus, a blue lotus, a red lotus, or a white lotus, born in the water, grown up in the water, rises well above the water and remains unsmeared by the water. It is just so, O bhikkhus, the Tathagata [though] born in the world, grown up in the world, dwells untarnished by the world, having overcome the world.”